RE012 – Competitive App Research: Calorie Counter+ (Nutracheck)

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Ticket – RE012

1. Introduction

Calorie Counter+ by Nutracheck serves as a food diary and nutrition tracker tailored for the UK, featuring a fully verified database and support across multiple devices.

The application prioritizes everyday usability while providing advanced users with detailed control. Personalization includes adaptable calorie and macro targets, a focus on seven essential nutrients, customizable meal structures, and habit reminders such as hydration and five-a-day prompts. Collectively, these elements create a personalized yet seamless experience that assists users in achieving their health objectives without causing cognitive overload (Nutracheck, 2025a; Google Play, 2025; App Store, 2025).

1.1 Methods & Scope — This swift competitive analysis utilized publicly accessible resources: the official website and product pages, listings on the App Store and Google Play, as well as coverage from third-party sources. The focus was on features that facilitate personalization (goals, reminders, diary setup) and user experience strategies that minimize friction while maintaining accessible configuration options (Nutracheck, 2025a; Google Play, 2025; App Store, 2025; BBC Good Food, 2024).

2. Core Features of nutracheck

• Customizable goals & nutrient focus — Users have the ability to establish personalized calorie and macro objectives for weight loss, gain, or maintenance, while also tracking 7 essential nutrients: carbohydrates, protein, fat, saturated fat, sugar, fiber, and salt. This allows for a diet-specific emphasis (e.g., increased protein) without confining users to strict plans (App Store, 2025; Nutrient Tracking, 2025).

• Notifications & habit encouragement — Integrated reminders for water consumption and 5-a-day servings assist users in sustaining healthy habits. The frequency of reminders is adjustable by the user, providing gentle accountability that prevents alert fatigue (App Store, 2025; BBC Good Food, 2024).

• Diary personalization — Users can modify meal labels, choose which nutrient badges to display, toggle trackers (water / 5-a-day / alcohol), and designate ‘easier’ days to adjust the weekly calorie allowance. These features tailor the diary to individual patterns while maintaining a straightforward default for beginners (Nutracheck Guide, 2023).

• Logging efficiency — Confirmed barcode scanning, photo-based searches, favorites, recipe and meal creation tools, along with Apple Watch widgets enhance the logging process. Device integrations (Apple Health, Fitbit, Garmin) minimize manual data entry and support a cohesive overview of intake and activity (Google Play, 2025; App Store, 2025; Apps & Devices, 2025).

3. Balancing Customisability with Ease of Use

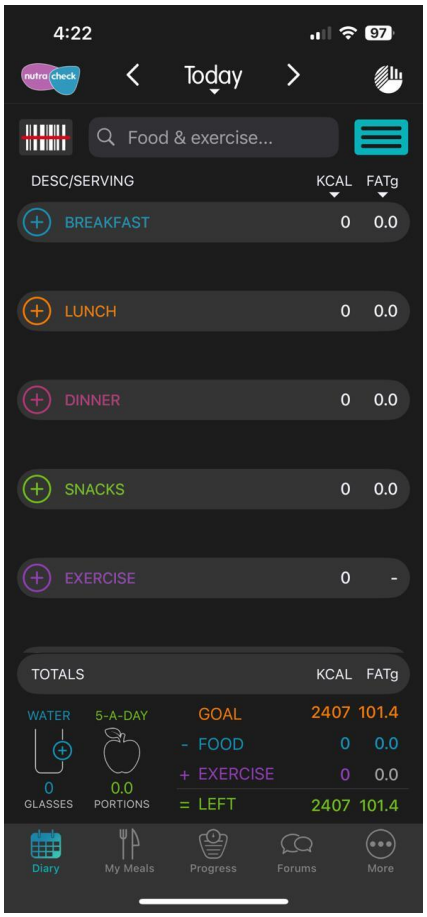
Calorie Counter+ prioritizes progressive disclosure: the default settings are straightforward (calories plus 7 nutrients), whereas advanced features (such as meal renaming, nutrient badges, and weekly flex) are hidden within the settings. This approach promotes recognition over recall and alleviates the configuration burden for new users. Additionally, traffic-light guidance and shortcut widgets further decrease the cost of interaction. Consequently, the system is designed to evolve from a simple ‘log-and-go’ method to a highly customized tracking experience as users become more sophisticated (BBC Good Food, 2024; Apps & Devices, 2025).

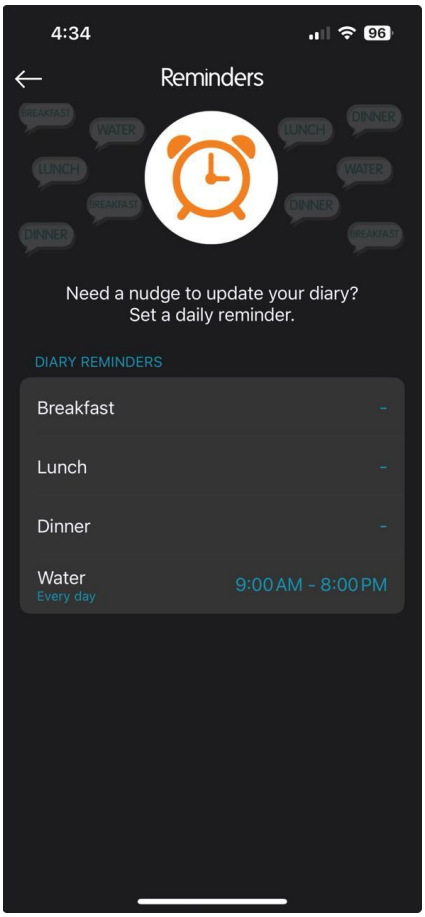
4. Observed Limitations (from public commentary)

• The accessibility of settings — Some reviewers have noted that altering more complex settings might appear less intuitive compared to competing applications (DietApp.ai, 2025).

• Discrepancies in activity synchronization — Feedback from the community suggests that there may be occasions where calories burned from general activity are overestimated when syncing with Apple Watch; this information is based on personal accounts and may vary depending on individual setups (Reddit, 2025).

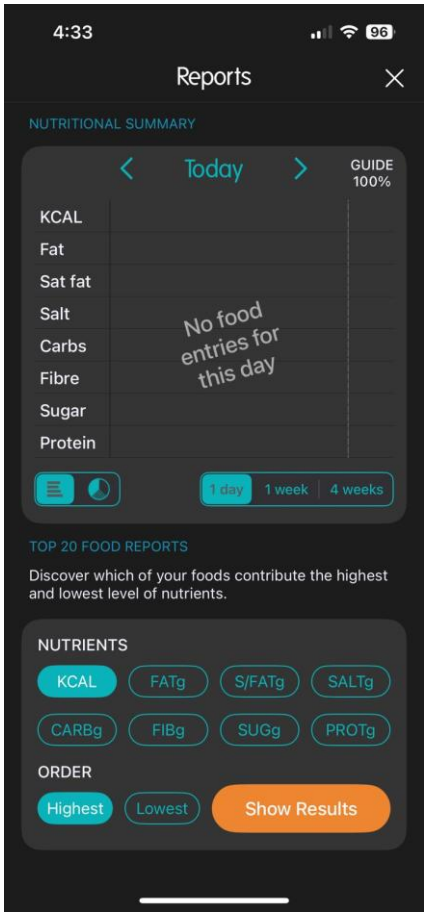
5. Screenshot

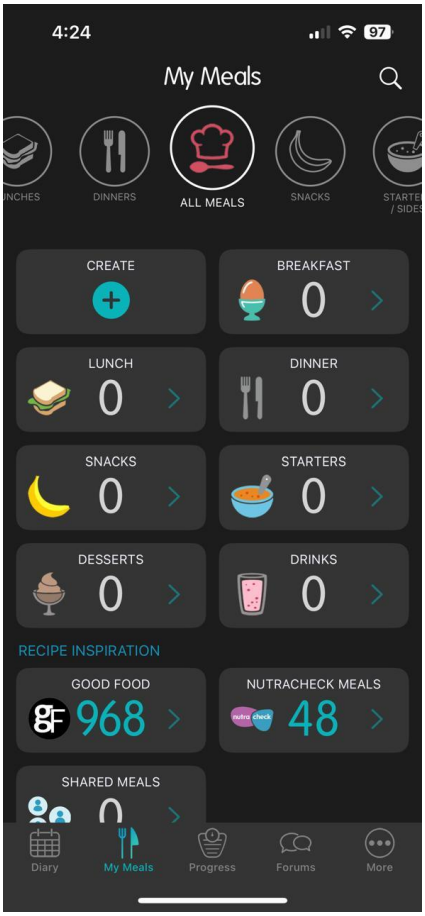




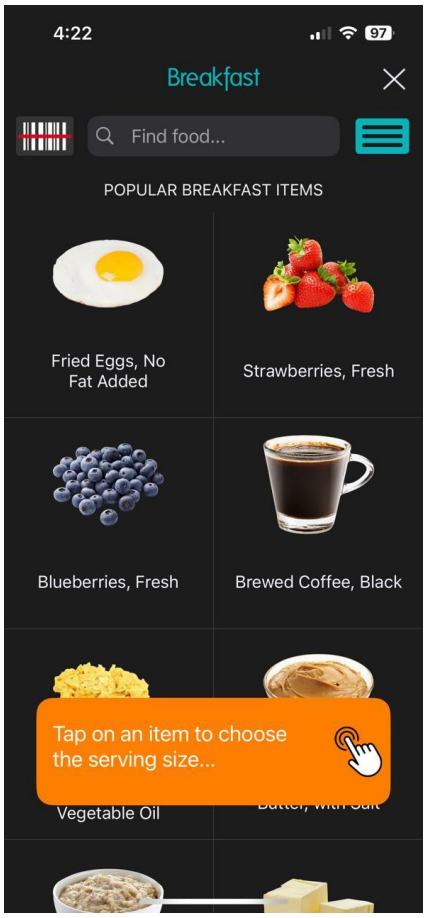
Home / Diary — nutracheck.co.uk or App Store listing (primary hero).

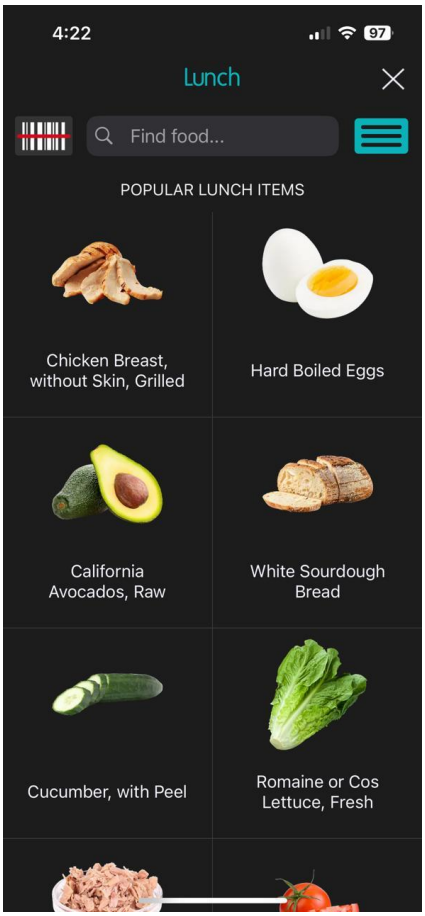
Reminders settings — ‘More’ ▸ ‘Reminders’ ▸ Water / 5-a-day.



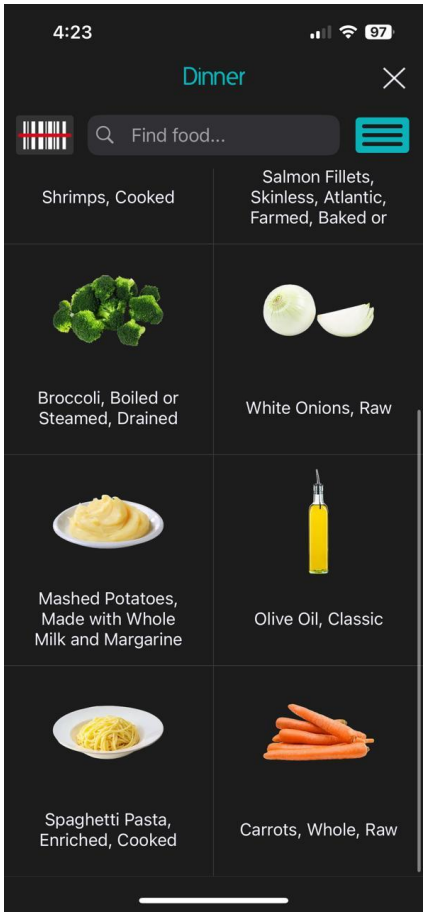


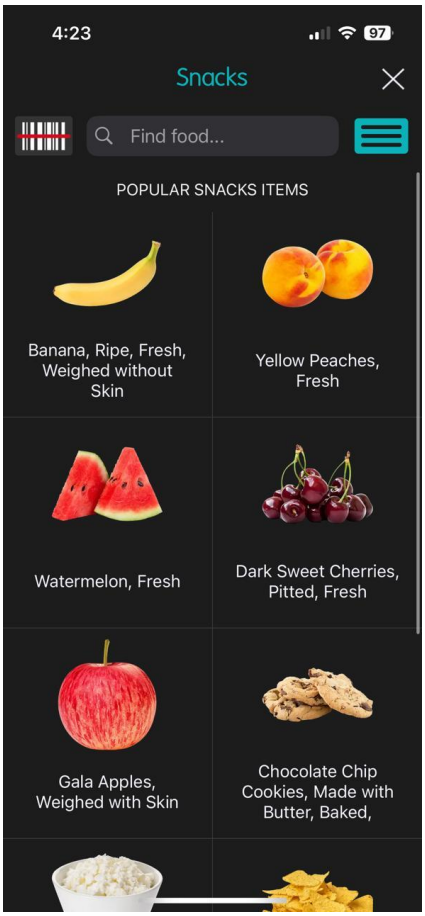
Goals & Macros — flexible targets UI.

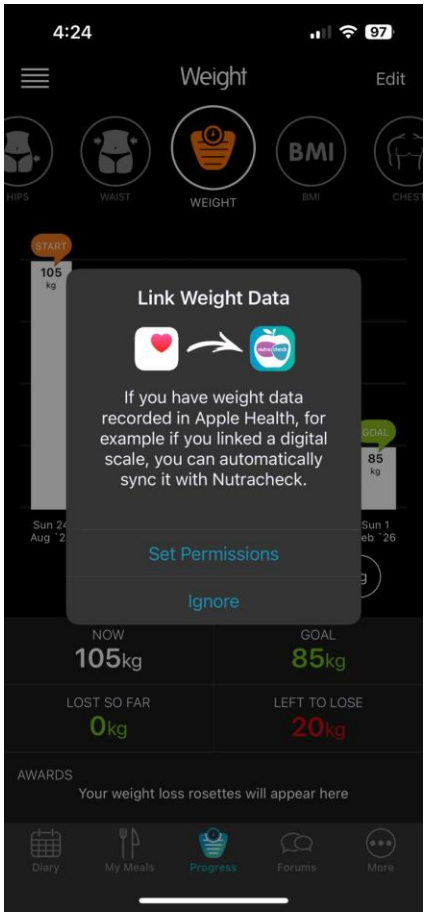


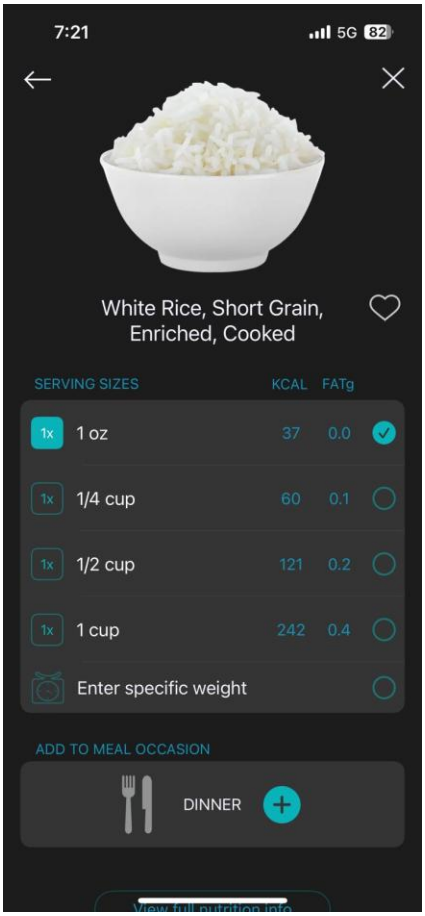


Diary customisation — rename meal occasions / nutrient badges.


4:23
97
Dinner
Find food...
Shrimps, Cooked
Salmon Fillets, Skinless, Atlantic, Farmed, Baked or
Broccoli, Boiled or Steamed, Drained
White Onions, Raw
Mashed Potatoes, Made with Whole Milk and Margarine
Olive Oil, Classic
Spaghetti Pasta, Enriched, Cooked
Carrots, Whole, Raw


4:23
97
Snacks
Find food...
POPULAR SNACKS ITEMS
Banana, Ripe, Fresh, Weighed without Skin
Yellow Peaches, Fresh
Watermelon, Fresh
Dark Sweet Cherries, Pitted, Fresh
Gala Apples, Weighed with Skin
Chocolate Chip Cookies, Made with Butter, Baked,





Integrations — Apple Health / Fitbit / Garmin screens.

6. Feature Comparison: Calorie Counter+ ↔ Food Remedy (UX opportunities)

Feature Area	Calorie Counter+ (Nutracheck) – What It Does	Opportunity for Food Remedy UX
Personalised Goals	User-defined calorie & macro targets; weekly flex with 'easier' days; 7-nutrient focus.	Expose a 'Quick Goals' wizard with safe presets + one-tap expert mode for granular macro splits.
Reminders / Nudges	Configurable reminders for water and 5-a-day; widgets; watch complications.	Offer context-aware nudges (time-zone aware, post-workout, missed-meal) with cadence control.
Diary Structure	Rename meal occasions; choose visible nutrient badges; toggle water/5-a-day/alcohol trackers.	Let users pin 2–3 custom trackers (e.g., sodium, fibre, fasting window) to the diary header.
Capture Speed	Verified barcode + photo search, favourites, recipe/meal builder; robust UK database.	Add on-device 'recent plate' recognition: surface last 10 meals with 1-tap portion edit.
Integrations	Apple Health / Fitbit / Garmin sync; watch widgets.	Two-way hydration sync + persistent conflict resolution (choose source precedence).

7. Key Recommendation for Food Remedy (inspired by Calorie Counter+)

Introduce an Adaptive Reminder Orchestrator (ARO). ARO personalises nudges across meals, water and 5-a-day using simple user-set preferences plus passive signals (typical logging time, missed-log patterns, local time zone). Default to 'Light' cadence to avoid alert fatigue, with 'Standard' and 'Intense' modes for motivated users. Provide an inline 'Snooze / Fewer nudges' control wherever a reminder appears. Success metrics: +15–20% 7-day log retention, +10% hydration goal attainment, and reduced same-day drop-off. This preserves ease for newcomers while enabling deeper control for power users (App Store, 2025; BBC Good Food, 2024).

8. Conclusion

Calorie Counter+ demonstrates how to reconcile breadth of control with everyday simplicity. Its personalisation toolkit—flexible goals, nutrient emphasis, diary configuration and scheduled reminders—lets users tailor the app to their routines without heavy setup. Translating these patterns into Food Remedy via an adaptive, user-respectful reminder system and modular diary widgets can elevate engagement while keeping the overall experience calm, legible and fast (Nutracheck, 2025a; Apps & Devices, 2025).

References

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• Nutracheck Guide. (2023). Customising diary & trackers (PDF). https://irp.cdn-website.com/49ea4c49/files/uploaded/Nutracheck%20guide.pdf

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• Reddit. (2025). User discussion on activity sync variance. https://www.reddit.com/r/mounjarouk/comments/1kwwe9u/nutracheck_overestimating_calories_burned_via/

• Nutracheck (2025a). About & product overview. https://www.nutracheck.co.uk/

Appendix – Sites for Screenshots

• Nutracheck website – https://www.nutracheck.co.uk/

• Google Play – Calorie Counter + (Nutracheck) – https://play.google.com/store/apps/details?id=com.nutratech.app.android

• Apple App Store – Calorie Counter+ by Nutracheck – https://apps.apple.com/gb/app/calorie-counter/id444924121

Additional Personalisation Surface Areas

• Diet pattern flexibility — Support for approaches like intermittent fasting (5:2 setting) and choosing focus metrics such as fibre or salt extends beyond calories, letting users align tracking with personal priorities (BBC Good Food, 2024).

• Weekly planning — 'Easier day' allocation redistributes weekly calories to accommodate social meals without punitive UI, preserving psychological safety while maintaining a weekly deficit (Nutracheck Guide, 2023).

Design Principles in Practice

• Progressive disclosure — Advanced settings remain available but out of the main flow.
• Opinionated defaults — Sensible starting points (calorie target, 7 nutrients) enable immediate success.
• Locality of reference — Reminders and trackers live close to the diary, reducing navigation overhead.
• Gentle pacing — Cadence controls for reminders mitigate alert fatigue and sustain adherence.

Implementation Notes for ARO

• Signals — Last-log timestamp, user-set meal times, device time zone, and streak state.
• Controls — Global cadence (Light/Standard/Intense) plus per-nudge toggles (Meals, Water, 5-a-day).
• Safeguards — Quiet hours, travel-day detection, and automatic dampening after repeated dismissals.
• Measurement — A/B test against current reminder model; track activation rate, opt-outs, streak length, and weekly retention (App Store, 2025; BBC Good Food, 2024).